
Step Forward on Sponsorships

Building New Revenue Through
Mission-Aligned Partnerships

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Welcome back! Here's our agenda

3-Part Work Session Agenda

01 **The Partnership Approach:** Shift to a Partnership Mindset

02 **Identifying the Right Partners:** Prospecting & Warm Leads

03 **Building the Sponsorship:** Workflow & Scenarios

Q&A and discussion of real-world scenarios encouraged! Drop ideas in the chat!

Assignment: Share Your Next Steps

Task: Identify some next-step actions you will take following this workshop to advance your sponsorship strategy. **Examples:**

New ideas: update a target list of 10 mission-aligned prospects.

Using your internal audit: draft a 1-page positioning statement detailing your products /audience

Reach out to 3 connections requesting a warm introduction to a specific organization for a discovery chat.

Commitment: Write these down and let's find ways to check in with each other to share how it's going!

The Partnership Approach: a quick refresher on our core concepts

The Approach Partnerships vs. sales. Our ideas are better together

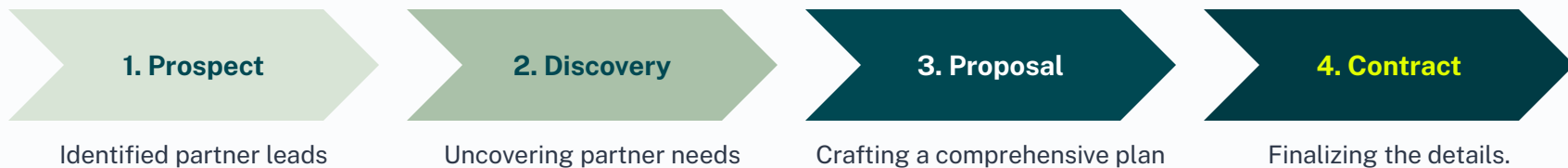
Comprehensive campaigns bring in ALL of your audience touchpoints and benefit you, the sponsor, and the audience.

Your existing network is the best place to start find mission-aligned partners (common ground on topics, regions, audiences) to **complement** your content

Prospecting is the first step of the process. In grant seeking, it's called research. Warm up potential partners by sharing content and making connections.

A Simple Sponsorship Workflow

The Sales Workflow



- The contract starts the partnership, but it doesn't need to be overly complex.
- No sophisticated tools or sales collateral are need to get started

Discovery: The 4 Key Questions

Review your internal audit and listen for the following:

01

Goals & Initiatives?

What are they trying to accomplish?

02

Target Audiences?

There might be more than one target audience.

03

Timing?

Start and end dates of the campaign.

04

Budget?

It's primarily about presence.

Bonus Points!

Is there anything else you would like to share with me?

Crafting a Simple Proposal

Based on what you learned during the Discovery conversation

Positioning

Who you are and the impact of your journalism.

Comprehensive

Digital messaging channels and ad sizes.



Dallas Free Press. For the people. With the people.
Our trusted, nonprofit journalism amplifies voices in disinvested Dallas neighborhoods and explores solutions to our city's systemic inequities.

The Trust for Public Land would like to reach residents of South Dallas communities this summer to request feedback on a proposed park project.

Trust for Public Land Program

Campaign Time Period: 30-Days (June 15-July 14, 2026)

Digital messaging cross-platform (details and ad sizes follow)

- Digital site Messaging
- E-Newsletter
- Text Messaging

Total Trust for Public Land Campaign Value and Net investment

Total Program Value - \$

Total Program Net Investment - \$

Discovery Details

Addressing key partner needs and campaign timing.

Pricing

Total value vs. total investment

Interactive Session

Scenarios

Putting partnership strategies into practice.

Scenario #1



Pricing Questions: Forming Your Plan

Can I see three proposals, priced high, medium, low? Do you offer discounts?

Scenario #2



Addressing Exclusivity and Editorial Input

We want exclusivity as a sponsor. Can we review content and make suggestions?

Scenario #3



Handling Objections & Rejections

Working with Newsrooms: Notes from the Field



News organizations want to collaborate with creator journalists, though there is no standardization on the how and why - an opportunity!

Value add: Revenue, social proof for sponsors, and new sourcing.

Creator journalist **strengths** to leverage: Platform expertise, content expertise, social reach, can share opinions, are trusted by audiences.

Contracting advice: Operate as a brand, not a freelancer; retain IP rights and focus on brand growth.

Action: Get on the radar of admired newsrooms - initiate discovery chats!

Open Discussion: Share Your Next Steps



- *What are some key next steps you want to tackle?*
- *How will you carve out time in your week?*
- *How can we support & hold each other accountable to reach some of these goals?*

Final Word

- Be confident and passionate. Earned revenue starts with YOU.
 - Earned revenue is business-sustaining revenue generated by what you are already delivering – your trusted brand, high-quality content and engaged audiences.
 - Sponsors invest in strength and solutions. Build excitement so others will want to invest.
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